initiatives, provide tangible solutions, conduct outreach meetings, spot inspections of major infrastructure projects and collect local grievances. In Kasaragode, Shri Parshottam Rupala along with other dignitaries inaugurated the event. The lighting of the lamp and the inauguration of the "Sagar Parikrama" song in Malayalam set the tone for a series of impactful discussions.

Shri Saji Cheriyan, Hon'ble Minister of Fisheries, Kerala and Chief Executive, National Fisheries Development Board, interacted with fishers at various locations, fostering interactions in Madakkara and Pallikkara Fishermen Colony, also witnessed progress in pearl cultivation. The beneficiaries passionately shared their experiences, shedding light on challenges like brackish water replenishment and insurance issues. "Sagar Parikrama" also joined the "Theera Sadassu" in Kerala, which was a similar initiative introduced by the Government of Kerala.

The visit to Beypore Harbour and Chaliyam Fish Landing Centre further deepened the engagement, with Shri Parshottam Rupala interacting with beneficiaries in Mahe (Puducherry). Certificates and sanctions related to PMMSY and KCC scheme were awarded to progressive fishermen, women beneficiaries, and young entrepreneurs, exemplifying the multifaceted impact of the program. The journey continued through Thrissur, Ernakulam and Kochi, addressing various aspects of fisheries sector development. Foundation Laying Ceremony of Cochin Fishing Harbour (Thoppumpady) during Sagar Parikrama was also joined virtually by Shri Sarbananda Sonowal, the Union Minister of Ports, Shipping & Waterways, and it marked a significant milestone, symbolizing the commitment to robust infrastructure.

Phase VIII: Navigating Tranquil Shores from Muthalapozhy to Kanyakumari

Embarking on an 8000-kilometer odyssey, Sagar Parikrama Phase VIII, spearheaded by Shri Parshottam Rupala, left an indelible mark on India's coastal narrative. Engaging with over 350 fishermen at Muthalapozhy and Vizhinjam, the Yatra unveiled ground realities, fostering a commitment to transformative change. Covering key districts like Thirunelveli, Thoothukudi, and Ramanathapuram, the Yatra facilitated direct interactions with 2000 fishermen and stakeholders, amplifying their concerns and aspirations.



Beyond rhetoric, the Yatra achieved tangible milestones, including the foundation laying of an exclusive Multi-Purpose Seaweed Park in Tamil Nadu, with a strategic investment of Rs. 127.7 crore in a hub and scope model comprising of a seaweed production park at Valamavur in Ramanathapuram along with a seaweed processing park at Kanthavakottai. Shri Rupala's assurance to consider demands for enhanced infrastructure, marine ambulances and increased insurance coverage mirrored a commitment backed by action. This phase stands not just as a symbolic journey but as a catalyst for sustainable livelihoods, blending the intricacies of coastal life with strategic policy initiatives of the Government, truly embodying the Yatra's mission, "Fishing for a better tomorrow."

To enhance sustainable and widespread engagement at the grassroots level nationwide, the Department has meticulously devised the strategic initiative known as the 'Matsya Sampada Jagrukta Abhiyan (MSJA),' which was officially launched on the 3rd Anniversary of PMMSY on September 15, 2023. These MSJA outreach programs are actively implemented during the Sagar Parikrama Program to ensure a comprehensive and impactful reach.

Phase IX: Coastal Odyssey from Thiruvandanai to Chennai

Embarking from Thiruvandanai, Tamil Nadu, Sagar Parikrama Phase-IX, led by Union Minister Shri Parshottam Rupala, set sail on a visionary journey, covering diverse coastal districts. Robust participation characterized the Yatra, engaging over 32,300 beneficiaries, including fishermen, fish farmers, and fisherwomen.

The first day featured Shri Parshottam Rupala, emphasizing the integration of new technology in the fishery sector at Thondi, Ramnad District. The inauguration of a fish farmer producer cooperative society and distribution of Kisan Credit Cards marked strategic moves toward empowering the fishing community. Progressing through various districts, discussions on PM Kisan Samman Nidhi took center stage at Mallipattinam Fishing Harbour, Thanjavur District. The Yatra continued its impactful journey through Mamallapuram, Kuppam Fish Landing Centre and Chennai, leaving an enduring footprint on the coastal landscape. The second and third days witnessed Shri Rupala's interactions, reviews on infrastructure projects, and discussions on schemes, reinforcing the Yatra's commitment to holistic development and sustainable fishing practices.

Initiation of Phase X: Unveiling a Sea of Opportunities in Andhra Pradesh

Shri Parshottam Rupala commenced the transformative Sagar Parikrama Phase X, embarking from Chennai to the coastal realms of Andhra Pradesh. This initiation of dynamic phase witnessed interactions with over 2000 participants, including fishermen, fisherwomen, entrepreneurs, and stakeholders of the Fish Food Festival in Nellore. The journey encapsulated Krishnapatnam, Nellore, and Ramnagar Fishing Village, fostering dialogues to address concerns, emphasizing on the sector's significance, encompassing 3 crore individuals along an 8000 km coastline, echoed a commitment to elevate the fisheries community.

As Sagar Parikrama Phase X will unfold along the 972 km Andhra Pradesh coastline, it will showcase the state's pivotal role in the fisheries industry, contributing 30% of the country's fish production. With an insightful exhibition and festival, the Union Minister underscored the importance of schemes like PMMSY, highlighting the goal to issue KCC to every fisher and to observe ground level implementation and providing insight for better approach. The event featured the distribution of Fish Kiosks, Live Fish Vending Centres and Insulated Vehicles, amplifying the transformative impact of PMMSY in empowering local beneficiaries.

Sagar Parikrama transcends beyond being a mere journey; it stands as a resounding saga of success. Boosting outreach to over 71.07 lakh fishermen, fish farmers and other stakeholders, the expedition has spanned more than 88 locations, covering a coastal length of more than 6000 km across 10 coastal states/UTs. This monumental effort has facilitated a comprehensive outreach through electronic, print, and digital media, featuring a massive campaign in 7 vernacular languages. The regional Sagar Parikrama song, played in native languages, has beautifully expressed gratitude towards the ocean, highlighted the significance of fishermen's livelihoods, and underscored their profound connection with the sea, resonating across the coastal belt. Remarkably, this journey has contributed to the issuance of KCC cards to benefit fishers and fish farmers in availing the credit facility to fishers and fish farmers, along with the sanctions for installation of 736 units of artificial reef, covering 10 coastal states/UTs. Through its multi-phased journey, the initiative spearheaded by Shri Parshottam Rupala, Hon'ble Union Minister of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry & Dairying, under the visionary leadership of Shri Narendra Modi, Hon'ble Prime Minister, has transcended beyond policy discussions and schemes touching the lives of fishers. By venturing into diverse coastal territories on the West and East Coast, meticulously addressing the ground-level challenges faced by fishermen, fish farmers, and other stakeholders, the Sagar Parikrama has not only showcased the Government's firm commitment to the fishers sector but has also highlighted the importance of sustainable practices, technological innovations with new amendments such as livelihoods increases resource management through artificial reef besides inclusive and equitable growth to fortify our the nation's fisheries ecosystem.